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Found Poem

Period 7

I Hear Pounding

A found poem from *Flowers for Algernon*

I hope they use me, I rely wanted to lern	(1,4)
He said I had good motor-vation	(4,9)
He said I had a good natcher and hes eeger to please	(9,10)
I dont know how to think or remembir, but he said	(15, 9)
just try	(15)
I get headakes and cant do the puzzels good	(18)
but he's not a dummy	(73)
He's normal - like everyone else	(73)
I hear pounding	(278)
Upward, moving, like a leaf in an upcurrent of warm air.	(282)
exploding outward toward the sun.	(282)
a giant sponge soaking in knowledge	(78)
Drifting and expanding through time and space	(282)
my astonishing growth had betrayed them	(106)
Our relationship, becoming increasingly	(113)
strained.	(113)
"ARTIFICIALLY-INDUCED INTELLIGENCE DETERIORATES	(255)
AT A RATE OF TIME DIRECTLY PROPORTIONAL TO THE	(255)
QUANTITY OF THE INCREASE."	(255)
I hear pounding	(278)
I can't go back down into that cave	(252)
My body was a shambles	(282, 173)
I know if I look down	(282)
I will see my shadow blotting out the earth.	(282)
I hear pounding	(278)
Im glad I got a second chanse ,	(310)
I lerned a lot of things that I never new were in this world,	(310)
Im grateful I saw it for a little bit	(310)
I did something but I dont remember what.	(311)
I hear pounding	(278)
Wait, it's gone	(195)
Goodby evrybody....	(311)

PART 2:

My poem is trying to show Charlie's thoughts on his intelligence and the way it affects him through time. I tried to pinpoint the most significant parts of his inclination and decline of intelligence throughout the book so the poem is almost like a timeline but it does not describe his other intelligence, but only describes is intellectual intelligence and how it affects him as a whole. At the beginning of my poem when I quoted, "I hope they use me, I rely wanted to lern", I tried to show that Charlie was very naive but eager for his intelligence to increase (1,4). He thought about why he wanted intelligence and this very line motivated him to do the operation which affected him in a very big way. Another way my poem shows Charlies thoughts on his intelligence and the way it affects him is when I quote, "Upward, moving, like a leaf in an upcurrent of warm air"(282). This shows that Charlie is thinking about how his intelligence is changing and what rate it is changing and then explained in later lines are how this increase in intelligence is affecting him in different ways. The example I gave in the poem was trying to elude that Charlie's relationship with his dumber self is becoming more and more distant or "strained". Part of this poem is about Charlie and the pounding going through his head which seems to be his old self hidden inside of him, when he is intelligent, but this slowly goes away when he has permanently changed to his old self.

I considered using some of the lines of the following passage in my poem, "When I touched her shoulder she stiffened and trembled, but I pulled her toward me. Then it happened. It started as a hollow buzzing in my ears... an electric saw... far away. Then the cold: arms and legs prickly, and finger numbing. Suddenly I had the feeling I was being watched. A sharp switch in perception. I saw, from some point in the darkness behind a tree, the two of us lying in each other's arms. I looked up to see a boy of fifteen or sixteen, crouching nearby. 'Hey!' I shouted. As he stood up, I saw his trousers were open and he was exposed" (100). I decided not to use any of this passage because even though it has much sensory detail and great explanations, none of the lines would do any good for my poem and if they did, I could easily compress my poem which would get rid of them. The ideas I'm trying to convey in my poem do not fit with most if not all of the passage because they talk about his emotional feelings towards a girl and when taken apart, they seem like meaningless lines. All of this imagery does not contribute any imagery to the feelings of Charlie towards his intelligence.

I titled the poem "I Hear Pounding" because it is one of the lines that I had repeatedly used in my poem for a dramatic effect so the thought of pounding would be in my readers mind. I hear pounding is really trying to show the strain and difficulty that Charlie is going through throughout the different stages of his operation. It puts perspective on how he thinks. My poem is also showing that Charlie's old self (mentally challenged self) is pounding through his head when he is changing, but when he is back to himself, he is not bothered.

One image I incorporated into my poem is "a giant sponge soaking in knowledge"(78). This quote not only shows the image of a sponge soaking up water or any liquid but it also is a metaphor for Charlie during his operation. During his operation Charlie was constantly gaining intelligence which relates to the quote because much like a sponge he is soaking up knowledge as if it were water. I decided to include this sense imagery because it shows Charlies progression and how he thinks he is learning and growing more intelligent through time.

I mainly tried to use repetition and stanza breaks the most throughout my poem to convey a more serious and dramatic tone. I used repetition with the words "I hear pounding" which was also the title of my poem. I wanted the pounding to represent the change that Charlie was going through and the inner Charlie slowly fading, then slowly coming back. I specifically put this on a tab line so the reader would take a small pause to say that sentence with a more dramatic and waiting effect. My stanza breaks were separated with each stage and idea of Charlies thoughts at those moments in his operation. The first stanza was his naive and vulnerable state when he was very mentally challenged. The second was his beginning progression through the operation and on the third stanza I tried to say that he was becoming more intelligent and rising above himself and the others around him. When I use the line "ARTIFICIALLY-INDUCED INTELLIGENCE DETERIORATES AT A RATE OF TIME DIRECTLY PROPORTIONAL TO THE QUANTITY OF THE INCREASE" on its own stanza, I'm trying to show that Charlie has realized something big and the rest of the stanzas show what the quote above means and how it changes him once again.

Charlies thought on his intelligence through time (QUOTES)

"You're a giant sponge soaking in knowledge"(78).

"I hope they use me becaus Miss Kinnian says mabye they can make me smart. I wan to be smart" (1)

- "I reely wanted to lern I wantid it more even than pepul who are smarter even then me" (4)
- "Burt said thats Algernon and he can do this amazed very good" (7).
- I dint feel bad becuase I watched Algernon and i lernd how to finish the amaze even if it takes me along time" (8).
- "He said I had a good motor-vation" (9).
- "Charlie has a good nathcer and hes intrusted and eeger to please"(10).
- "I tolld him I dont know how to think or remembir and said just try"(15).
- "And I cant do the puzzels good"(18).
- "I get headakes..." (18).
- "Some times somebody will say hey lookit Frank, or Joe or even Gimpy. He really pulled a Charlie Gordon that time. I don't know why they say it but they always laff and I laff too." (23)
- "One thing? I, like: about, Dear Miss Kinnian: (thats, the way? it goes; in a business, letter (if I ever go! into business?) is that, she: always gives me' a reason" when - I ask. She"s a gen'ius! I cou'd be smart like-her, Punctuation , is? Fun!" (39).
- "Now I know what they mean when they say 'to pull a Charlie Gordon.' I'm ashamed." (42-43)
- "I was seeing them clearly for the first time - not gods or even heroes, but just two men worried about getting something out of their work." (69)
- "He's not a dummy. He's normal. He'll be just like everyone else"(73).
- "When I touched her shoulder she stiffened and trembled, but I pulled her toward me. Then it happened. It started as a hollow buzzing in my ears... an electric saw... far away. Then the cold: arms and legs prickly, and finger numbing. Suddenly I had the feeling I was being watched. A sharp switch in perception. I saw, from some point in the darkness behind a tree, the two of us lying in each other's arms. I looked up to see a boy of fifteen or sixteen, crouching nearby. 'Hey!' I shouted. As he stood up, I saw his trousers were open and he was exposed." (100)

- "It had been all right as long as they could laugh at me and appear clever at my expense, but now they were feeling inferior to the moron. I began to see that by my astonishing growth I had made them shrink and emphasized their inadequacies. I had betrayed them, and they hated me for it." (106)
- "Our relationship is becoming increasingly strained. I resent Nemur's constant references to me as a laboratory specimen. He makes me feel that before the experiment was not really a human being." (113)
- "What did you expect? Did you think I'd remain a docile pup, wagging my tail and licking the foot that kicks me? I no longer have to take the kind of crap that people have been handing me all my life." (123)
- "The ice had broken between us and the gap was widening as the current of my mind carried me swiftly into the open sea." (125)
- "Shadows out of the past clutch at my legs and drag me down. I open my mouth to scream, but I am voiceless. My hands are trembling, I feel cold, and there is a distant humming in my ears." (132)
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- "The place was a shambles. There were dozens of little folding snack-tables, all covered with twisted tubes of paint, most of them crusted dry like shriveled snakes, but some of them alive and oozing ribbons of color... Three overstuffed chairs and a mangy green couch were piled high with discarded clothing and on the floor lay shoes, stockings, and underthings, as if she were in the habit of undressing as she walked... A fine layer of dust covered everything." (173)
- "Nothing in our minds is ever really gone. The operation had covered him over with a veneer of education and culture, but emotionally he was there - watching and waiting." (195)
- "I'm not your friend. I'm your enemy. I'm not going to give up my intelligence without a struggle. I can't go back down into that cave. There's no place for me to go now, Charlie. So you've got to stay away." (252)
- "ARTIFICIALLY-INDUCED INTELLIGENCE DETERIORATES AT A RATE OF TIME DIRECTLY PROPORTIONAL TO THE QUANTITY OF THE INCREASE." (255)
- "I hear the pounding" (278)
- "Upward, moving, like a leaf in an upcurrent of warm air. Speeding, the atoms of my body hurtling away from each other. I grow lighter, less dense, and larger... larger... exploding outward toward the sun. I am an expanding universe swimming upward in a silent sea. Small at first, encompassing with my body, the room, the building, the city, the country, until I know that if I look down I will see my shadow blotting out the earth. Light and unfeeling. Drifting and expanding through time and space." (282)
- "Im glad I got a second chance in life like you said to be smart because I lerned a lot of things that I never even new were in this world and Im grateful I saw it all even for a little bit." (310)
- "Anyway I bet Im the frist dumb persen in the world who found out some thing inportent for sience. I did something but I dont remember what. So I gess its like I did it for all the dumb pepul like me all over the world." (311)

Goodby Miss Kinnian and dr strauss and evrybody.... (311)